from an ancestor sufficiently ape-like to be placed in the same group with the existing great apes. Man could no longer be regarded as the Lord of Creation, a being apart from the rest of nature. He was merely the representative of one among many Families of the order Primates in the class Mammalia.

However, as time went on the approach changed. The fact of evolution had been established and was no longer in need of further proof. Later, the underlying mechanisms of genetics and variation were discovered and the principle of natural selection was established as the method of evolution. It now remained to study the course of evolution as a process.

This approach yielded several important new points of view. In the first place, not only did discovery still further enlarge the time-scale of evolution, so that it now has to be measured not in millions but in thousands of millions of years, but emphasis began to be laid on its future as well as on its past. It became clear that man had as vast spans of time before him as those he had enjoyed for his entire evolution from his first submicroscopic ancestor. Secondly, evolution came to be increasingly looked at as a process of realization of new possibilities, and so involving an element of progress. And thirdly, evolutionary succession, in which an earlier successful or dominant type is wholly or largely replaced by a new and biologically improved type, began to be studied. Darwin had noted and correctly interpreted a few cases of succession. It now became clear that succession was a widespread and indeed general fact of evolution, and constituted the method by which major evolutionary advance was achieved. The reason that the reptiles were largely replaced by the mammals as dominant land vertebrates was because the mammals were in a perfectly legitimate sense of the world *higher* organisms than the reptiles. It further emerged that man constitutes the latest dominant group, and is today, thanks to his new method of evolving by the cumulative transmission of experience, the only type capable of realizing important new possibilities and of achieving further major advances in the future. Thus, in the light of the science of evolutionary biology which Darwin founded, man is seen not just as a part of nature, but as a very peculiar and indeed unique part. In his person the evolutionary process has become conscious of itself, and he alone is capable of leading it on to realizations of possibility. A century after Darwin’s modest statement that light will be thrown on the origin of man, we can truly say that, as a result of Darwin’s work in general and of *The Origin of Species* in particular, light has been thrown on his destiny.